TIMOTHY J. OWEN, D.M.A., Saxophone Performance

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

I'm a saxophonist, music educator, and curriculum specialist with three decades in professional performance and teaching. My career spans eight years in university settings and over twenty years teaching applied saxophone across contexts. My work bridges classical, jazz, and contemporary genres, with a scholarly focus on Edwin Gordon's Music Learning Theory and performance psychology drawn from Army resilience training. Music has blessed my life abundantly, and I hope to help students at BYU-Idaho discover how technical mastery and spiritual growth reinforce each other.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Saxophone Instructor & Curriculum Developer | *U.S. Army School of Music* | *Virginia Beach, VA* | *Jul. 2009-Sep. 2013*

- Instructed 100+ students, achieving 100% course completion rate over 4 years through targeted remedial strategies
- Created curricula incorporating Music Learning Theory principles from doctoral research
- Contributed to curriculum development for Advanced Individual Training course for ~4,000 Army musicians
- Designed performance rubrics and assessment instruments aligned with occupational standards
- Coached ten diverse ensembles: saxophone quartets, brass bands, and non-traditional instrumental combinations

Interim Instructor, Saxophone | *University of Iowa* | *Iowa City, IA* | *Feb. 2002*

- Taught graduate and undergraduate saxophone students during professor's medical leave
- Developed individualized lesson plans focusing on technical proficiency and musical interpretation
- Prepared students for juries and recitals with constructive feedback

Teaching Assistant, Jazz Studies | *University of Iowa* | *Iowa City, IA* | *Aug. 2003-May 2004; Aug. 2000-May 2001*

- Evaluated assignments and performances for approximately 150 students across multiple jazz studies courses
- Presented lectures in professor's absence on jazz history, ensemble techniques, and improvisation
- Led small group exercises in improvisation, focusing on chord-scale relationships
- Mentored undergraduate students in practice strategies and performance preparation

Teaching Assistant, Music Theory | *University of Iowa* | *Iowa City, IA* | *Aug. 2001-May 2003*

- Conducted aural skills training in small groups
- Consulted individually with students during office hours to address specific learning challenges
- Assisted in development of instructional materials aligned with course learning outcomes

Adjunct Professor, Saxophone | *Kirkwood Community College* | *Cedar Rapids, IA* | *Sep. 1999-Aug. 2001*

- Instructed saxophone students (majors and non-majors) through individualized curricula
- Designed lesson plans addressing technical development, musicianship, and repertoire preparation
- Maintained studio of 3-4 students per semester with consistent retention

Adjunct Professor, Woodwinds | *Snow College* | *Ephraim, UT* | *Sep. 1997-Jun. 1999*

- Instructed saxophone and oboe students (majors and non-majors) through customized curricula
- Taught approximately 150 students in Introduction to Music (MUS 1010) courses over 4 semesters
- Presented lectures on music history, theory fundamentals, and active listening skills

Teaching Assistant, Saxophone | *Brigham Young University* | *Provo, UT* | *Various semesters 1994-1999*

- Taught 2-3 undergraduate students per semester under faculty supervision

PROFESSIONAL ENSEMBLE PERFORMANCE & LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Saxophonist & Woodwind Section Leader | *America's First Corps Band* | *JBLM, WA* | *Oct. 2013-2025*

Principal Saxophonist: Concert Band and Ceremonial Ensemble (2013-2025)

Section Leader: Pacific Beat Jazz Combo, Bullseye Brass Band

Performed approximately 60 concerts annually throughout Pacific Northwest

Provided individual instruction to 8-12 military musicians annually

Supported Multinational Military Exercise "Talisman Saber" in Australia (2023)

Presented educational clinics at regional schools throughout Pacific Northwest

Saxophonist | *Eighth Army Band* | *Camp Humphreys, Republic of Korea* | *Nov 2017-Oct 2018; Mar. 2022-Feb. 2023*

Ensemble Leader: Peninsula Winds Quintet (2022) - performed bassoon part on baritone saxophone

Performed with Dragon Sound Brass Band, Ceremonial Ensemble, and Concert Band

Supported United States-Korea alliance and cultural exchange programs

Saxophonist | *First Armored Division Band* | *Wiesbaden, Germany* | *Feb 2006-Jun 2009*

Performed with Jazz Combo, Rock Band, Saxophone Quartet, Ceremonial Ensemble, Concert Band

Deployed in support of Operation Iraqi Freedom (2007-2008)

Performed over 200 concerts in Germany, Iraq, and Kuwait

SELECTED SOLO PERFORMANCE EXPERIENCE

Concerto Performances

Winner, University of Iowa Concerto Competition (2003)
Muczynski Concerto, Op. 41 with University of Iowa Wind Ensemble, Dr. Myron Welch, conductor

Winner, BYU Concerto Competition (1998)
Dubois Concerto with BYU Orchestra, Dr. Clyn Barrus, conductor

Featured Soloist, BYU Wind Symphony Eastern U.S. Tour (1997)
Bencriscutto Serenade, Dr. David Blackinton, conductor

World Premieres

Coles, Adelaide. Sonata for Alto Saxophone and Piano (2011) - Premiere: Chandler Hall, Old Dominion University, Nov. 2012

Judson, Tohm. Steps.X for Tenor Saxophone and Electronic Tape - World premiere: Harper Hall, University of Iowa, Apr. 2003

Solo Recitals

University of Iowa: 5 recitals (May 2004, Apr. 2003, Apr. 2002, Mar. 2001, May 2000)

Brigham Young University: 4 recitals (Mar. 1999, Apr. 1997, Jun. 1996, Mar. 1995)

Repertoire spanning Baroque through contemporary works, standard classical literature, and newly-commissioned pieces

Community Ensemble Performances

Olympia Jazz Senators, Olympia, WA (Early 2024-Present) - Second Tenor Saxophone

Olympia Musical Theatre Singers (4 annual concerts) - Bass Vocalist

EDUCATION

University of Iowa | Doctorate of Musical Arts, Saxophone Performance | Iowa City, IA | 2005

Dissertation: "Integrating the Music Learning Theory of Edwin E. Gordon with a Beginning Saxophone Curriculum"

Committee: Kenneth Tse (Chair), Don Coffman, Mark Weiger, Benjamin Coelho, Richard Olson

Primary Instructors: Kenneth Tse, Patrick Jones, Matthew Sintchak

Winner, University of Iowa Concerto Competition (2003)
Muczynski Concerto, Op. 41 with University of Iowa Wind Ensemble, Dr. Myron Welch, conductor

Brigham Young University | Master of Music, Saxophone Performance | Provo, UT | 1999

Advisor: C. Raymond Smith. Primary Instructors: C. Raymond Smith (saxophone), William Holman (clarinet)

Winner, BYU Concerto Competition (1998)
Dubois Concerto with BYU Orchestra, Dr. Clyn Barrus, conductor

Brigham Young University | Bachelor of Music, Saxophone Performance and Pedagogy | Provo, UT | 1997

Primary Instructors: C. Raymond Smith, Daron Bradford

Featured Soloist, BYU Wind Symphony Eastern U.S. Tour (1997)
Bencriscutto Serenade, Dr. David Blackinton, conductor

STUDENT SUCCESS

U.S. Army School of Music Students (2009-2013)

Geoff Pennington: Second Successor, Saxophone Instructor, U.S. Army School of Music; continues in leadership roles in the Army band field.

Adam Muller: Army Band Doctrine Writer, U.S. Army School of Music; defines regulations affecting the entire Army band career field of 4,000+ musicians.

Collin Ferrell: Active professional jazz saxophonist; maintains regular performing schedule in Oklahoma.

Chris Condon: Developed saxophone performance skills into media production company based in Germany.

Bryan Lydeen: Saxophone Professor and Director of Jazz Studies, University of Mary, North Dakota.

Matthew Zettlemoyer: Transitioned to Air Force Bands (significantly more competitive than Army bands).

University Teaching Students

Scott Sandberg (University of Iowa, 2002): Tenured Professor of Saxophone, University of North Dakota; recently stepped down as Music Department Chair to return to full-time teaching.

Dennis Watters (Kirkwood Community College, 1999-2001): Created successful dance band performing regularly in Iowa City/Coralville area for approximately 10 years.

TEACHING PHILOSOPHY & PEDAGOGICAL APPROACH

My teaching prioritizes student-centered instruction that empowers learners to break down musical challenges and synthesize them into expressive performances, cultivating creative problem-solving that extends beyond music into discipleship and everyday life. I draw from Edwin Gordon's Music Learning Theory to address specific audiation needs, ensuring foundational gaps are bridged for sustained progress.

In environments like BYU-Idaho, this supports holistic mentoring that harmonizes technical expertise with personal development and gospel principles. Drawing from Army resilience training, I integrate principles that parallel King Benjamin's counsel in Mosiah 4:30 to "watch your thoughts, and your words, and your deeds." This helps students manage performance anxiety while recognizing that we control our thoughts, words, and actions: spiritual truths that transcend secular training.

I teach performance as selfless service rather than self-focused achievement. Dr. C. Raymond Smith taught me to consider how Christ would approach performance: not as self-aggrandizing but as offering something to the audience. Orson Scott Card's "Art as an Act of Charity" reframed my pursuit of excellence as developing God-given gifts like the parable of the talents. At BYU-Idaho, I aim to provide world-class musical training while cultivating spiritual experiences students can draw upon to discern truth, developing intellectual rigor to articulate gospel truths with their Spirit-born testimonies.

PEDAGOGICAL SPECIALIZATIONS

Music Learning Theory

Diagnose audiation gaps—moments when students struggle to hear musical relationships internally—and design targeted interventions. Prevents over-reliance on rote methods and undirected exploration.

Jazz Pedagogy

Teach improvisation through systematic development: ear training on recorded solos, transcription with analysis, pattern practice across twelve keys, and gradual increase in harmonic complexity.

Ensemble Direction

Direct saxophone quartets, brass bands, jazz combos, and non-traditional combinations. Adapt techniques to ensemble type while maintaining consistent musicianship standards.

At-Risk Student Support

Four years at the Army School of Music required developing strategies for students arriving behind peers. Achieved 100% completion through individualized assessments, remedial protocols, and incremental goal-setting that built confidence alongside competence.

Performance Psychology

Integrate Army Master Resilience Training principles with scriptural teachings on thought management. Help students recognize that anxiety stems from overestimating threat while underestimating capability—and that reframing performance as service reduces both.

COURSES PREPARED TO TEACH

Applied Saxophone Lessons (all levels)
Saxophone Ensemble
Jazz History
Jazz Theory and Improvisation
Jazz Ensemble Direction (large and small ensembles)
Brass Band and Contemporary Wind Ensembles
Music Theory & Aural Skills
Woodwind Literature and Pedagogy
Woodwind Methods
Music Appreciation

RESEARCH & CREATIVE WORKS

Published Research

Owen, Timothy J. (2005). "Integrating the Music Learning Theory of Edwin E. Gordon with a Beginning Saxophone Curriculum." Doctoral dissertation, University of Iowa. UMI Dissertations Publishing.

- Explores practical applications of Gordon's audiation-based theory in saxophone pedagogy
- Provides curriculum model enhancing early skill acquisition and musicianship through sequential learning
- Directly applicable to BYU-Idaho's mission of serving students with diverse preparation levels

Research Interests

Instrumental pedagogy and Music Learning Theory applications for addressing audiation gaps

Curriculum development for beginning wind instruments with measurable outcomes

Resilience training and performance psychology in music education

Commissioned Works

Judson, Tohm. Steps.X for Tenor Saxophone and Electronic Tape (2003). World premiere: Harper Hall, University of Iowa, April 2003.

Arrangements & Adaptations

Gounod, Charles. Repentir (O Divine Redeemer), arranged for Saxophone Quartet (2021). Recorded in Joint Base Lewis-McChord chapel and distributed by Army chaplains for Easter devotional use.

Coffin, Jeff. Harmonized etudes from The Articulate Jazz Musician, adapted for big band saxophone section and brass quintet (2022).

Performance Portfolio

Available at timowen.me/saxophone, includes: DMA recital (2004); Coles Sonata premiere (2012); O Divine Redeemer (distributed by Army chaplains, 2023); Silent Night devotional (Army Band virtual performance, 2023).

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Master Resilience Trainer Level 2: Train-the-Trainer Certification
Comprehensive Soldier and Family Fitness Center, Fort Jackson, SC | Mar. 2016

40-hour intensive course based on University of Pennsylvania positive psychology research

Specialized training in 14 resilience skills including Goal Setting, ATC Model, and Energy Management

Integrated into pedagogical approach for addressing performance anxiety

Master Resilience Trainer Level 1: Resilience Skills Instruction
CSF2 Center, Joint Base Lewis-McChord, WA | Jun. 2015

80-hour intensive course taught by University of Pennsylvania psychology faculty equivalent

Core competencies directly applicable to student performance anxiety management

Senior Leader Course | *U.S. Army School of Music | Virginia Beach, VA | Feb. 2020*
Advanced Leader Course | *U.S. Army School of Music | Virginia Beach, VA | Aug. 2011*
Army Basic Instructor Course | *U.S. Army School of Music | Virginia Beach, VA | Sep. 2009*

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Professional Service

North American Saxophone Alliance (NASA), Member

Educational clinics and masterclasses at regional high schools (annual)

Workshops on performance preparation and audition techniques

Adjudicator for regional jazz festivals (periodic)

Church Service

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints | 1980-Present

As a member of the Church, I have been blessed to serve in various leadership capacities. Each responsibility has offered service opportunities and leadership development that enrich my teaching and strengthen my testimony.

These callings have taught me principles of shepherding, mentoring, and building Zion communities—skills that directly enhance my ability to guide students in their musical and spiritual development.

Bishopric Second Counselor (2016-2017)

Ward Mission Leader (2015-2016)

Sunday School First Counselor (2014-2015)

Elders Quorum Presidency First Counselor (2025-Present)

Elders Quorum Presidency Second Counselor (2009-2013)

Ward Choir Director (2000-2005)

Early Morning Seminary Teacher (2019-2020, 2023-2025)

Branch Music Coordinator and Mission Leader, Republic of Korea (2017-2018, 2022-2023)

Musical Service In Worship

Music has been my primary avenue for worship and testimony-bearing. Through performance, I strive to invite the Spirit and help others feel God's love.

Accuser and False Witness soloist, Rob Gardner's Lamb of God (2015-2019, 2021, 2023-2026)
15 total performances throughout Tacoma/Olympia area

O Divine Redeemer saxophone quartet recording (2021)
Distributed by Army chaplains for Easter devotional use

Regular special musical numbers in sacrament meetings (saxophone and voice)

Missionary Service | The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints | Ukraine Kiev Mission | 1992-1994

I served a full-time mission in Ukraine immediately following the dissolution of the Soviet Union. This experience profoundly shaped my testimony and taught me to rely on the Holy Ghost. I learned the Russian language and gained deep appreciation for Ukrainian culture.

The mission taught me that the gospel is universal and that people everywhere hunger for truth—insights that inform how I approach students from diverse backgrounds and help them recognize that their God-given musical gifts are stewardships to be magnified.

HONORS & AWARDS

Military Service Recognition

Meritorious Service Medal, United States Army (2013)

> "For exceptionally meritorious service as a Saxophone Instructor, Trainer, and a member of the Staff Concert Band, Saxophone Quartet, Staff Brass Band, and Big Band. Staff Sergeant Owen was crucial to the development of the Army Musician Advanced Individual Training Course and an overall asset to the Institute. His professionalism, dedication and commitment to students and fellow staff members are in keeping with the highest traditions of military service and reflect great credit upon him, the Soldier Support Institute and the United States Army."

Honorable Discharge, United States Army (2025)

Army Commendation Medals (Multiple)

Competitive Performance Awards

Winner, Concerto Competition, University of Iowa School of Music (2003)

Winner, Concerto Competition, Brigham Young University School of Music (1998)

Featured Soloist, BYU Wind Symphony Eastern United States Tour (1997)

SPECIALIZED COMPETENCIES

Additional Instruments: Clarinet (intermediate), Flute (intermediate), Oboe (basic), Bassoon (basic)

Languages: English (native); Russian (advanced); French (basic)

Technology: Finale 26, Dorico 5, Audacity, Python, basic video editing and graphic design

Performance: Classical saxophone, jazz, chamber music, large ensemble, extended techniques (didgeridoo emulation on baritone sax)

Administrative: Curriculum design, assessment, resource allocation

WORKSHOPS

Tom Jackson's Live Music Method Workshops | U.S. Army School of Music | 2010-2013

Participated in twelve two-day workshops over three years (four iterations annually) led by Tom Jackson

Learned to teach performance as designed audience experience: focusing on transitions, emotional flow, setlist sequencing, and creating memorable moments for listeners

Dr. Noa Kageyama Workshop | U.S. Army School of Music | 2011

Participated in workshop by Dr. Noa Kageyama (The Bulletproof Musician) on performance psychology

Focused on sports psychology applications to musical performance: mental preparation, anxiety management, and peak performance strategies

REFERENCES

Dr. Kenneth Tse

Professor of Saxophone | Doctoral Committee Chair and Primary Instructor
School of Music, University of Iowa
3717 UCC, Iowa City, IA 52242
Phone: (319) 335-1660 | Email: kenneth-tse@uiowa.edu

Dr. Kenneth Tse served as my doctoral committee chair and primary saxophone instructor at the University of Iowa. He is an internationally recognized saxophonist and pedagogue who can speak to my performance abilities, teaching potential, and scholarly work on Music Learning Theory.

Dr. C. Raymond Smith

Professor of Saxophone, Retired | Advisor and Primary Instructor
School of Music, Brigham Young University
Phone: (801) 636-0708 | Email: raysmithstudio10@outlook.com

Dr. Raymond Smith was my primary saxophone instructor and advisor throughout both my bachelor's and master's degrees at Brigham Young University. He profoundly influenced my understanding of performance as service and introduced me to Christ-centered approaches to music-making. He can speak to my long-term development, teaching philosophy formation, and alignment with BYU values.

Dr. Matthew Sintchak

Professor of Saxophone | Primary Instructor
School of Music, University of Wisconsin-Whitewater
950 W. Main Street, Whitewater, WI 53190
Phone: (262) 472-5710 | Email: sintcham@uww.edu

Dr. Matthew Sintchak was one of my primary instructors during doctoral studies at the University of Iowa. He can speak to my performance skill, pedagogical development, and commitment to excellence.

Dr. Russell Houser

Director of Strategy, Warrant Officer Historical Foundation | Former Commander, 56th Army Band
3614 Marcliff Road, Hope Mills, NC 28348
Phone: (910) 263-5487 | Email: dr.russell.houser@mail.com

Dr. Russell Houser was my commanding officer at America's First Corps Band. He can speak to my performance leadership, mentorship of junior musicians, and professional excellence in diverse contexts.

Command Sergeant Major Joseph Camarda, USA (Ret.)

Former Commandant, U.S. Army School of Music
4868 Admiration Dr., Virginia Beach, VA 23464
Phone: (757) 270-2019 | Email: j_camarda@yahoo.com

Command Sergeant Major Camarda was the Commandant during my tenure as Saxophone Instructor. He supervised my curriculum development work and awarded me the Meritorious Service Medal. He can speak to my ability to achieve measurable student outcomes and mentor students across skill levels.